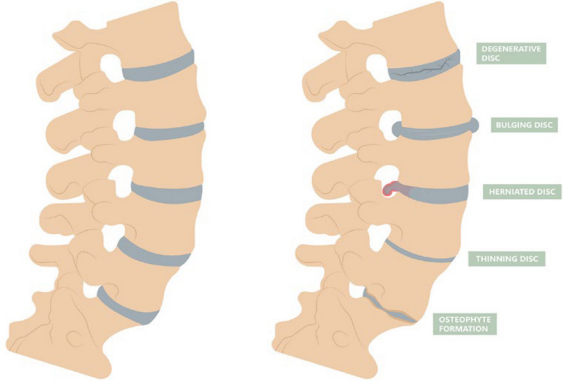
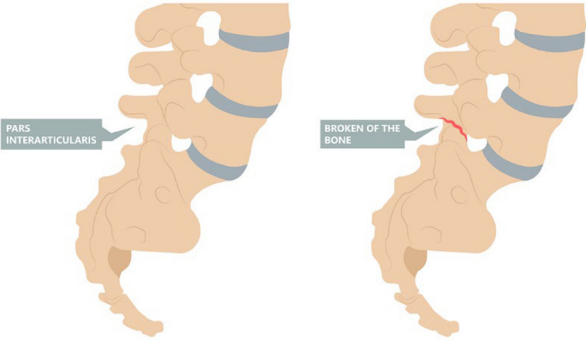


Common Lower Back Injuries in Bodybuilding



Injury Type	General Information	Symptoms	Relevant Risk Factors
Lumbar Radiculopathy (Nerve Pain)/Herniated Disc/Degenerative Disc Disease  NORMAL DISC DEGENERATIVE DISC DISEASE <i>Adapted from Pemporon/Shutterstock.com</i>	Refers to a set of conditions that produces irritation at the level of the nerve root resulting in characteristic pain, weakness, numbness in a relatively predictable pattern depending on the level of the lumbar spine where the injury/problem occurs.	Pain with sitting that may produce pain, numbness, and/or tingling with the potential presence of muscle-specific weakness due to nerve innervation; typically feels better in standing position.	Flexion and rotation movements of the spine increases stress to the discs.
Lumbar Spondylolysis (Stress Fracture to Lumbar Vertebrae)  HEALTHY SPINE SPONDYLOLYSIS <i>Adapted from Pemporon/Shutterstock.com</i>	A condition typically in the lower lumbar vertebrae (L4-L5) that produces characteristic feelings of lower back pain and instability.	Feelings of instability and pain during sitting that reduce in standing; may have excessive lumbar lordosis (low back arch) posture as a compensation for lack of dynamic stability.	Weightlifting in extended spinal positions.

Common Lower Back Injuries in Bodybuilding



Injury Type	General Information	Symptoms	Relevant Risk Factors
Lumbar Muscle Strain/Ligament Sprain 	Associated with localized pain in the lower back because of either muscle or ligament damage that typically heals with time and rest.	muscle strains more provocative with resisted movements, whereas ligament sprains more provocative with end range spine movements.	History of trauma.

Injury Map/wikimedia.org

All data from (Gordon et al., 1991; McDonald et al., 2021; Reiman, 2016)